

Tasmania



THE ISLAND OF TASMANIA was once part of mainland Australia, but it is now separated from southeastern Australia by the Bass Strait. Tasmania has a cool, wet climate. The western part of the island contains rainforest that is home to many animals. Tasmania's isolation has allowed some animals to develop into unusual forms or separate species. Species have been threatened by introduced species, such as rabbits, although not as badly as those in mainland Australia. Clearing forest for logging and mining is the biggest issue.

Forest demon

The Tasmanian devil's name comes from its black coloring and its eerie, whining snarl. It has strong jaws and teeth that can crush bones. It eats all of its prey—bones, fur, skin, or feathers—leaving nothing behind.



KING ISLAND

BASS STRAIT

Big mouth

The quoll is a pouched mammal that comes out mainly at night to hunt. Its jaws can open wide to show its pointed teeth. The quoll has sharp claws and ridged pads on its back feet for climbing.



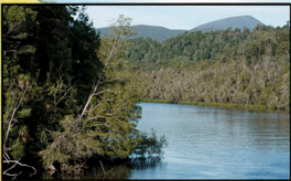
Ground parrot
(*Pezoporus wallicus*)
Length: up to 12 in (30 cm)



Spotted-tailed quoll
(*Dasyurus maculatus*)
Body length: up to 2 ft 6 in (76 cm)



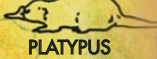
Tasmanian devil
(*Sarcophilus harrisi*)
Body length: up to 2 ft 1 in (65 cm)



Thick vegetation covers the banks of the Franklin River in southwestern Tasmania.



Many of the mountainous areas of Tasmania are covered by forest.



PLATYPUS

Lake Mackintosh

Great Lake

TASMANIA



SPOTTED-TAILED QUOLL



THYLACINE



RUFOUS-BELLIED PADEMELON



GROUND PARROT

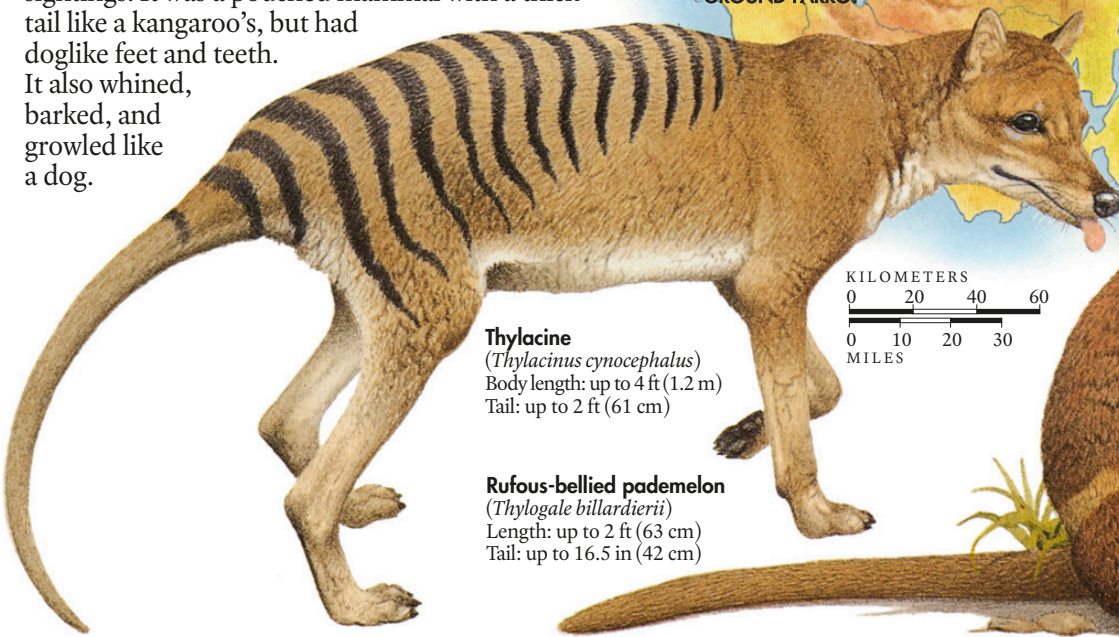


TASMANIAN DEVIL

Lake Gordon

Rare wolf

The thylacine or Tasmanian wolf is declared extinct, although there have been unverified sightings. It was a pouched mammal with a thick tail like a kangaroo's, but had doglike feet and teeth. It also whined, barked, and growled like a dog.



Thylacine
(*Thylacinus cynocephalus*)
Body length: up to 4 ft (1.2 m)
Tail: up to 2 ft (61 cm)

Rufous-bellied pademelon
(*Thylogale billardieri*)
Length: up to 2 ft (63 cm)
Tail: up to 16.5 in (42 cm)



Platypus
(*Ornithorhynchus anatinus*)
Length including tail: up to 25 in (63 cm)
Bill: up to 2.4 in (6 cm)

Tunneling wallaby

The rufous-bellied pademelon is a type of kangaroo that takes shelter in the undergrowth. If a pademelon is alarmed, it may thump the ground with its back legs to warn others of approaching danger.

